

GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

OVERPOWER

A 3v3v3 PvP arena game built on territory economy and modular ability builds.



THREE TEAMS / ONE ARENA / ONE SURVIVOR

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VISION

Vision Statement

Project OverPower is a 3v3v3 PvP arena game that reimagines MOBA-style strategy through three-team play, a territory-driven economy, and modular ability builds. Instead of gaining an insurmountable lead via stat items, players evolve their combat identity through ability upgrades and equipment-like utility choices.

The action takes place in an artificial digital environment where the players must fight in a gauntlet to determine who gets to keep their individuality and who gets assimilated into "The Stream".

The goal is to create a fast, readable, high-agency competitive experience where strategic positioning, opportunistic attacks, and smart build adaptation matter more than raw numerical scaling.

Executive Summary

This concept introduces a triple-threat competitive structure on a triangular map with three outward lanes and a contested central zone. Each team must simultaneously pressure two opponents while protecting their own capital, creating dynamic macro choices and constant shifting risk.

Progression is driven by a single resource generated through territory control. Instead of buying stat-focused items, players invest in upgrading and customizing their abilities. This approach aims to reduce game-winning leads and reward situational decision-making and skill expression.

On a moment-to-moment level, gameplay focuses on direct movement and aiming as well as outmaneuvering opponents both mechanically and strategically. Combat emphasizes positioning, timing, and adaptability rather than traditional auto-attacks or rigid role execution, keeping the action readable and mechanically expressive.

The match evolves when the first team is eliminated, transforming the map into a two-team battlefield to accelerate the endgame and reduce stalemate risk.

Target Audience

This analysis is based on the gamer types Quantic Foundry identified in their research, since it covers the majority of archetypes when it comes to video games.

PRIMARY AUDIENCE

The "Skirmisher"

- Wants fast-paced team arenas
- Prefers match-based resets

- Needs constant excitement and momentum

SECONDARY AUDIENCE

The "Gladiator"

- More invested, competitive, improvement-oriented mindset
- Likely to engage with meta, builds, and mastery layers

The "Ninja"

- Thrives on competition and challenge
- Cares about personal skill

Player Persona

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Age	18 - 24
Plays	Ranked arenas, fast competitive sessions, squad or solo

MOTIVATIONS

- Clean and quick fights and skirmishes
- Clear objectives
- Intense, high-stakes gameplay
- Every match to feel unique

FRUSTRATIONS

- Grind-first progression
- Overencumbered systems that are hard to get into
- Relying too much on teammates, especially random players

WHY THIS GAME FITS

- 3v3v3 creates constant, intense gameplay windows with fewer teammates but the same number of enemy threats as a 4v4 or 5v5 game. Individual impact results in more interactive gameplay.
- An ability-first economy makes outplays feel earned, not purchased.
- The lack of PvE focus avoids stale gameplay where players have to "farm" resources.

Target Platforms

1 - PC (PRIMARY)

- Best fit for a competitive audience and precision aiming
- Easiest platform for early community testing

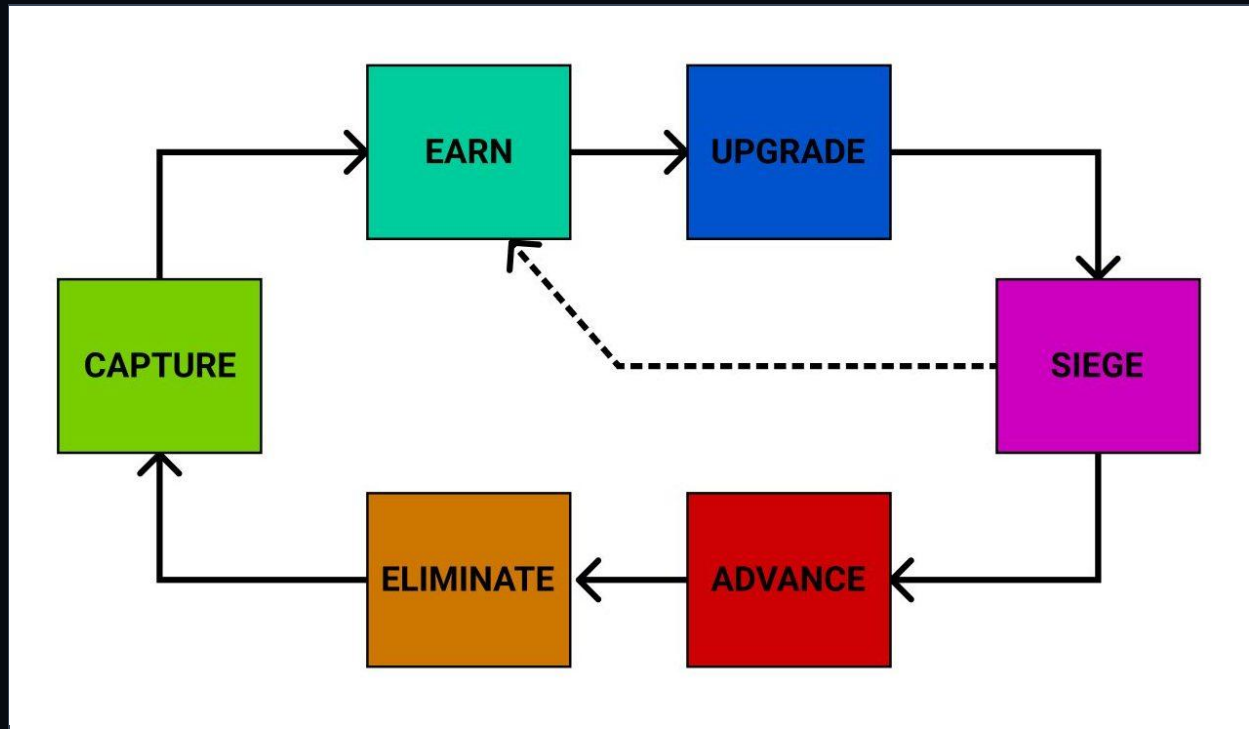
2 - MOBILE (SECONDARY)

- Viable because the main combat language is aiming projectiles and AoE
- Potential support tools: light aim-assist, simplified targeting UI

3 - CONSOLE (TERTIARY)

- Theoretically compatible
- Not in scope for this concept phase

GAME LOOP



The core loop: capture, earn, upgrade, siege, advance, eliminate

01**CAPTURE**

Secure adjacent territories to expand influence.

02**EARN**

Generate gold through controlled zones.

03**UPGRADE**

Return to a secured territory to invest in ability upgrades and new loadout options.

04**SIEGE**

Use built advantages and positioning to win skirmishes and contest enemy lanes.

05**ADVANCE**

Take control over the enemy capital.

06**ELIMINATE**

Defeat their remaining team members and repeat until you are the last team standing.

NARRATIVE

Story

It started with Soulscape, the first consumer application to let users project their consciousness into a persistent digital world through a neural implant. Inside it, biology became negotiable. Pain, fatigue, disability, appearance - all of it could be left behind. Identity stopped being something you were born into and became something you designed. Over generations, more people chose to live behind the glass than in front of it.

The world that powered Soulscape didn't get the same courtesy. Energy, cooling infrastructure, rare minerals, constant maintenance: reality became a neglected machine room. There was no single catastrophic day. Just a slow, compounding debt. Until the numbers finally surfaced and couldn't be ignored: Earth wasn't dying tomorrow. But it was dying soon enough that every delay had become a death sentence.

Humanity looked outward. A colony ship was designed. A destination was chosen. And then came the number that broke every institution that tried to handle it: forty percent. That was the capacity.

The answer, in the end, came from the same system that had already reshaped what it meant to be human: the Stream. Not as a spectacle. As a filter. Every human steps forward. Every human competes. The gauntlet does not care about legacy, wealth, or sentiment. It recognizes one thing: the ability to stay intact when everything around you collapses. Because in a future built on scarcity, that is the only resource that cannot be manufactured.

The ones who win keep their identity. The ones who do not are absorbed, their consciousness folded into the Stream itself, to assist the journey they could not earn a seat on.

Step forward. Prove you're worth keeping.

Characters

Every contestant entering the gauntlet is a real person, and they look like one. Character customization is not cosmetic decoration; it is a reflection of the narrative's core premise. In a world where identity is something you author, how you present yourself inside the simulation is a statement. Players build their appearance from the ground up, carrying their chosen self into the arena. The only restriction is that each contestant's figure has to be humanoid.

The only figure who stands apart is Desmond Dwight, the architect of Soulscape, and the first human being to ever construct a stable digital representation of his own consciousness. Without him, the Stream would not exist. Without the Stream, there would be no gauntlet, no ship, no future. He is, depending on who you ask, either humanity's greatest benefactor or the man most responsible for the condition it now finds itself in.

What Desmond actually is at the time of the gauntlet remains deliberately unclear. Whether a preserved consciousness, an evolving entity, or something else entirely is a question that remains unanswered.

World

The Real World

The physical world didn't collapse dramatically. It hollowed out. As Soulscape adoption grew across generations, the infrastructure required to sustain it - server farms, cooling grids, rare-earth supply chains - consumed resources faster than any climate model had accounted for. Cities restructured around connectivity hubs. Agriculture was automated out of necessity. Governments merged or dissolved depending on whether they sat near the energy corridors that kept the servers alive.

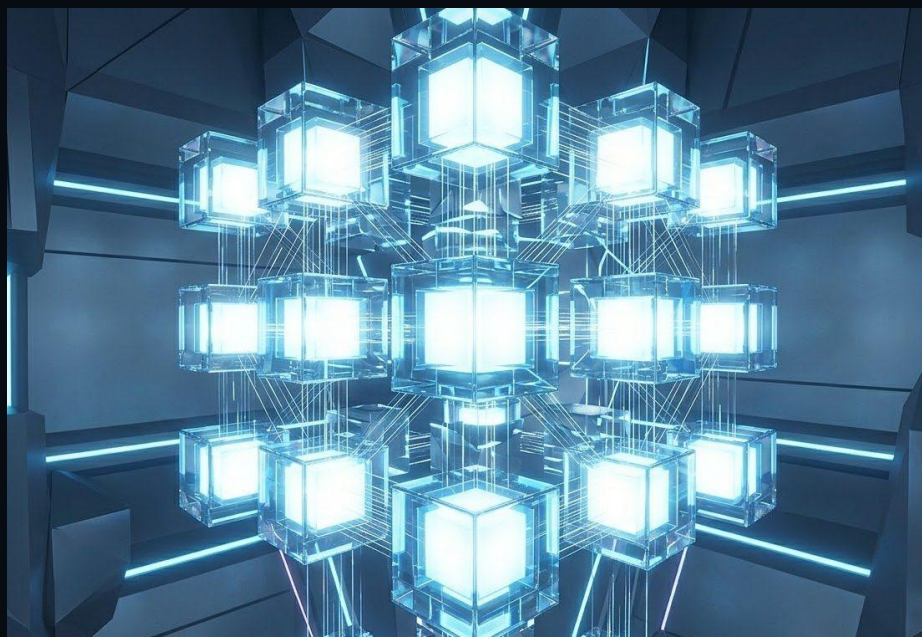
Most people still had bodies. They simply stopped prioritizing them.

Society and Belief

Two broad cultural identities emerged over time, though the line between them blurred constantly. The Immersed were those who spent the majority of their lives inside Soulscape, working, socializing, building families and communities entirely within the digital environment. For them, the physical world was maintenance: eating, sleeping, the bare minimum. The Grounded were those who resisted full immersion, either out of principle, poverty, or distrust of the technology. They kept physical trades alive and were disproportionately responsible for the infrastructure everyone depended on, a fact that created deep and lasting resentment on both sides.

Religion fractured and reformed around one central question: is a digital consciousness a real one? Some traditions held that the soul could not be copied or transferred. Others evolved to treat the Stream as something closer to an afterlife, a place where consciousness continued, connected, and contributed to something larger than any single life.

The Stream



The Stream began as a byproduct: the aggregated background noise of millions of connected minds. Over time it became something more structured, a shared layer beneath individual experience, almost like a cultural unconscious made legible. When the colony crisis arrived and assimilation became policy rather than metaphor, the question of what the Stream was and what it wanted became suddenly urgent. No one had thought to ask before.

Desmond Dwight had been inside it longer than anyone.

Narrative Integration

The narrative of OverPower is communicated through the arena itself and the events that unfold during a match. Every player who enters a game is participating in The Stream's gauntlet whether they know the lore or not. The goal is to ensure that key match moments carry emotional and thematic weight through visual, audio, and environmental cues alone.

MATCH START

The players are rendered into the arena at their respective capitals. This moment should feel like arrival, not spawn. Audio and visual cues should suggest the environment activating around the players: lights initializing, territory structures powering on, the arena assembling itself.

DURING THE MATCH

The Stream does not intervene in gameplay, but it is constantly observing the gauntlet and subtly reflects the state of the match by changing the environment accordingly. Audio design supports this through ambient tones that shift in intensity as territorial control changes, communicating rising stakes without text on screen.

TEAM ELIMINATION

The most narratively significant moment. In the fiction, a team's consciousness is being absorbed into The Stream. The derezzing of the eliminated section should feel like absorption, not destruction, with audio suggesting assimilation. The arena got smaller, the stakes got higher, and someone did not make it.

VICTORY

The winning team has proven they are worth keeping. The arena responds by stabilizing or resolving into a cleaner state, as if The Stream has accepted its result. The tone is not celebratory in a traditional sense but earned and final.

DEFEAT

Defeat is absorption, not death. Rather than a simple loss screen, the visual treatment should suggest the player's perspective dissolving or merging into something larger. The tone is inevitable.

MECHANICS, DYNAMICS & AESTHETICS

This game's design operates across two interconnected layers: micro-level moment-to-moment execution and macro-level strategic control. The overview below is split to showcase this.

NOTE

This is an overview. For more in-depth explanations of certain mechanics it is recommended to read the Systems section first.

Micro Layer

MECHANICS

- Direct movement and aiming input
- Ability activation and cooldown management
- Modular primary ability upgrades
- Armor break, regeneration, and health damage rules
- Reactive mobility and defensive tools

DYNAMICS

- High-frequency positioning and spacing decisions
- Short engagement cycles driven by armor breakpoints
- Tactical disengage into re-engage patterns (flanking, pinching)
- Skill expression through ability timing and aiming, upgrade synergies, and mechanical accuracy under pressure
- Improvisation and adaptability during chaotic multi-team fights

AESTHETICS

- Responsiveness and control - players feel directly responsible for success or failure in fights.
- Moment-to-moment tension - armor break, cooldown windows, and mobility create constant threat assessment.
- Personal mastery - improvement is felt through cleaner execution, smarter ability usage, and finding the most efficient build for each scenario.

Macro Layer

MECHANICS

- Three teams of three members each
- Territory adjacency and capture rules
- Tiered zone income and regeneration bonuses
- Gold as a territory-only resource

- Purchase restrictions tied to safe zones
- Capital capture and phase-based elimination rules
- Dynamic map reduction after team elimination

DYNAMICS

- Easier coordination and more agency with only two other teammates
- Strategic route planning and territory prioritization
- Risk-reward tradeoffs between income, safety, and exposure
- Team splitting versus grouping decisions
- Opportunistic third-party engagements
- Shifting alliances and threat assessment in three-team play
- Comeback windows created by capital-down states

AESTHETICS

- Strategic tension - every territorial decision carries long-term consequences.
- Uncertainty - incomplete information and third-team presence shape cautious play.
- Narrative drama - last-stand defenses and counter-captures create emergent stories that are fun to watch, not only to play.
- Agency at a team level - victory feels earned through planning, coordination, and map control, not just mechanical skill.

Micro-Macro Interaction

While presented separately, the two layers are interdependent:

- Micro execution determines the outcome of macro objectives.
- Macro positioning defines when and where micro skill is tested.
- Economic and territorial advantages amplify mechanical expression.
- Poor macro decisions force high-risk micro play.

THIS INTERPLAY ENSURES

Mechanical skill alone is insufficient without strategic awareness.

Strategic play collapses without reliable execution.

CONTROLS

ACTION	INPUT
Movement (top-down perspective)	W A S D
Aiming	Cursor position
1st Ability - Primary	Left click
2nd Ability - Secondary / Utility	Right click
3rd Ability - Ultimate	Space bar
4th Ability - Movement	Left Shift
Expand map	M
Shop	P
Scoreboard	Tab

SYSTEMS

Player Kit & Progression

DESIGN INTENT

Players do not select pre-defined hero kits. Instead, they build combat identity through modular ability choices and upgrades. This sandbox approach supports high experimentation during early testing and allows for playstyle variety with a smaller system footprint. Since there are no 3v3v3 MOBA-style games, it is hard to predict what types of playstyles may emerge, so this method seemed the most appropriate approach.

Movement, Aiming & Vision

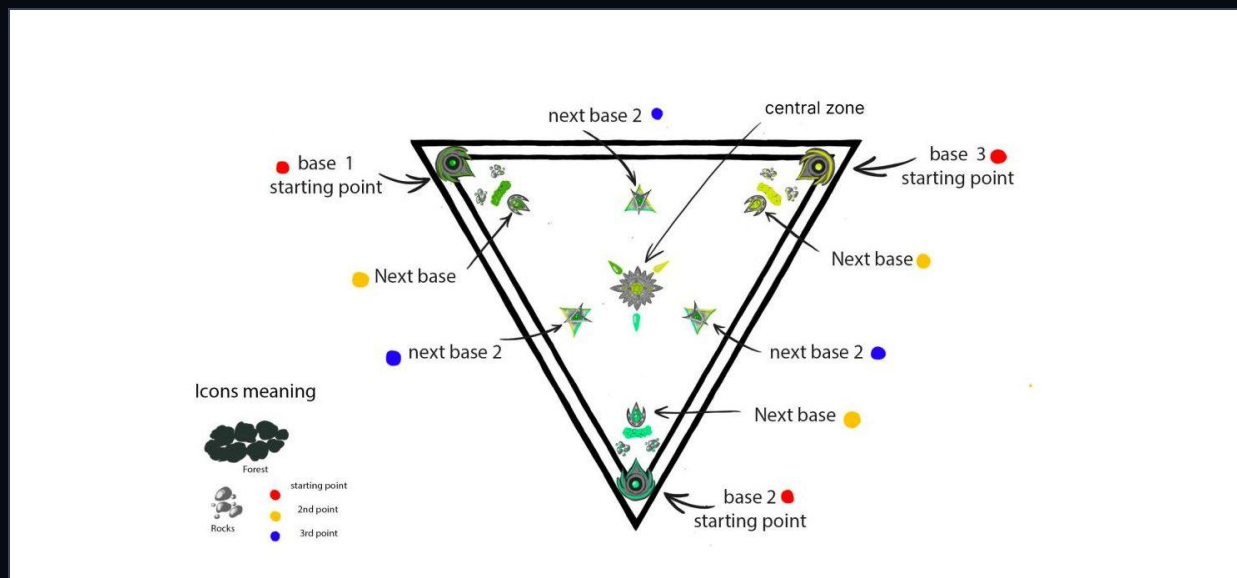
WASD movement and mouse aiming with a top-down perspective has a lower skill floor and is more intuitive for players inexperienced in the MOBA genre, while remaining similar enough to classic MOBA controls for experienced players to migrate.

The player can see in a wide cone in the direction of the cursor and a small circle around them to reveal any threats in their proximity, but vision does not go through walls. Teammates also have shared vision.



Vision cone reference, from the game SuperVive

Health & Armor



- Health bar: 100 HP
- Armor bar: level dependent

Health regenerates only in Tier 2 and Tier 1 territories, fastest in Tier 1.

Armor regenerates after 6 seconds out of combat and can soak up to 25 points of damage before breaking. Armor can be upgraded up to three times throughout a game. The player chooses between two upgrade paths: one increases the damage the armor absorbs before breaking, the other decreases the time before the shield starts recharging.

LEVEL	ABSORPTION PATH	RECHARGE PATH
Level 1	25 HP	6 seconds
Level 2	50 HP	4 seconds
Level 3	100 HP	2 seconds

Ability Slots

1ST SLOT - PRIMARY ABILITY (LEFT CLICK)

The bread and butter of the kit: a core projectile-based offensive tool that evolves through multiple modular upgrades. This allows for more skill expression when aiming abilities and evens out the playing field.

For easier balancing, the following parameters affect every version of the primary fire, with a few exceptions:

- Size (projectile)
- Speed (projectile)
- Damage (per projectile)
- Accuracy (bullet spread)
- Fire rate
- Distance
- Overheat
 - When moving: normal accuracy stat

- When standing still: 1.5x increase, taking effect the moment the movement vector is 0, to enable strafing

OVERHEAT MECHANIC

A resource bar that fills each time the player uses their primary ability, depending on their overhear stat. It automatically starts dropping after 1.5 seconds of not shooting, going down by 25 points per second. The maximum is 100. When the bar fills, the player is silenced until it drops back to 0.

At the start of the game the player has two choices:

- A semi-automatic pistol that does more damage per bullet, has bigger range and better accuracy when standing still
- An automatic pistol with increased fire rate, less overhear per bullet and better accuracy while moving

The next upgrade is the most impactful, since it adds an effect that changes the projectile the weapon shoots. If the player upgrades to a rocket launcher the projectiles now explode on impact; if they want projectiles to pass through multiple enemies they can upgrade to circular saws. This upgrade also affects the parameters and depends on the first choice: the semi-automatic pistol unlocks the long range tree, and the SMG unlocks the close quarters tree.

For the final upgrade the player has at least two choices based on their previous significant upgrade. Rockets can split into two smaller, faster rockets at a 90 degree angle, or come two at a time and charge up to four rockets that converge on the cursor. A circular saw can bounce off walls up to twice for increased damage per bounce, or return to the caster, dealing damage both ways.

COMBINATION PHILOSOPHY

Upgrades are designed to create emergent effects through stacking. Players can further improve their build with the remaining ability slots to cover weaknesses and tailor the build to their playstyle.

2ND SLOT - EQUIPMENT ABILITY (RIGHT CLICK)

A starting-choice utility and tech slot that adds match-context tools or provides a good offensive/defensive combo for the rest of the kit. This slot is a core tool for strategic adaptation.

3RD SLOT - ULTIMATE (SPACE)

Ultimate power is gated by a resource meter generated through active combat participation: damage dealt, damage taken, kills and assists. This ability changes the tides of a fight, having a significant effect when used through an increased power budget. This ability needs to be purchased.

4TH SLOT - MOVEMENT (LEFT SHIFT)

Players choose one survivability or mobility tool at the start of the game. This ability helps with closing gaps, initiating fights and creating distance.

5TH SLOT - PASSIVE

A purchasable modifier supporting specialization or patching weaknesses.

Player Progression

At the start of the game players have a level 1 armor shield, a movement slot ability, an equipment ability, and one of the two starting weapons.

After the initial primary ability upgrade, players may purchase or repurchase additional primary upgrades, the ultimate ability, an equipment ability, a movement option, and passives, in any order, to match preferred playstyle and match context.

PURCHASING RULES

- 1 Players must return to a captured territory and be out of combat for at least 5 seconds to purchase upgrades.
- 2 The specific gold costs are WIP and will be tuned through playtesting. Current placeholder values can be used for prototyping only.
- 3 Upgrades can be undone for a 50% refund, to allow adaptation without enabling constant re-specs.

Territory System

CORE PRINCIPLES

- Territories are tiered and require adjacency control: a player may only capture a territory if they control an adjacent one.
- To capture a zone the player must stay in a small area around it for a set amount of time depending on the tier.
- The game uses one primary resource: gold. Gold is earned only through territory control.
- The Tier 4 territory has a special perk that reveals the state of adjacent territories every 10 seconds.

TERRITORY	CAPTURE TIME	INCOME
Tier 4 - Central Zone	15 sec	10 gold/sec
Tier 3	10 sec	10 gold/sec
Tier 2	15 sec	5 gold/sec
Tier 1 - Capital	20 sec	None

EXCEPTION

Capturing an enemy capital grants a gold bonus when that team's members are eliminated during the capital-down phase.

Gamemode Structure

TEAM STRUCTURE

The match features three teams of three players each.

WIN CONDITION

The objective is to become the last team standing by capturing enemy capitals and winning the resulting elimination phases.

OVERPOWER MECHANIC

If a player is attacked by both enemy teams within a 3 second interval near a territory they control, then whenever that player drops under 35 HP they regenerate their shield instantly and gain a 10% increase in three of the highest parameters on their primary ability, while nullifying the overhear mechanic. If the player moves more than 15 meters from that territory the buff expires instantly, whether it was triggered or not.

This is intended to reward outnumbered defense and reduce third-party bullying against the defending team.

BOUNCE BACK MECHANIC

If a team holds a Tier 3 or Tier 4 territory for more than 5 minutes without interruption it receives a bounty. When an enemy team takes control of it, they receive that bounty instantly.

Elimination Logic

PHASE 1 - THREE TEAMS ALIVE

A team is only eliminated when their capital is captured, and all their members are eliminated afterward.

This creates a "last stand" window, where the threatened team can reclaim their capital, or capture an enemy capital to remain in contention. This rule is a core tension driver and will require testing for pacing and clarity.

TRANSITION BETWEEN PHASES

- When the first team is eliminated, their capital and connected route are removed.
- If the players who lost their original capital capture an enemy capital before getting wiped, that becomes their new capital.
- The map shifts from a triangle into a two-lane isosceles trapezoid: one longer lane, one shorter lane, and fewer territories to capture.
- All Tier 3 territories become neutral and all teams return to their capital.

This mechanic is intended to maintain pace and eliminate unnecessary portions of the map.

PHASE 2 - TWO TEAMS ALIVE

The "last stand" rule is removed to avoid infinite stalemates. The remaining enemy team is eliminated upon losing control of their capital.

Meta Progression

DESIGN INTENT

In-match progression resets every round. Meta progression provides a persistent layer outside individual matches and serves two purposes: it controls the rate at which new players are exposed to content, and it gives long-term players a reason to keep engaging across seasons. The system is split into three layers, each operating on a different timescale and serving a different player need.

Layer 1 - Content Unlock Funnel

New players start with access to both starting weapons and one upgrade path per tree: the rocket launcher for the long range tree and the sawblade launcher for the close quarters tree. All other ability slots are fully available from the start to allow experimentation from the first match.

After each completed match following their first game, players are presented with the remaining locked primary weapon paths and may freely choose which to unlock next. Each unlock grants the full weapon path including both final upgrades, so the player is never locked into a partial build and every unlocked path is immediately competitive.

The number of matches required to unlock the full arsenal scales with the number of available weapon paths. At the current content level of four remaining paths, the full unlock takes approximately four matches. As new weapon paths are introduced through seasonal content drops, the funnel extends naturally, re-engaging the unlock experience for all players.

Layer 2 - Mastery Track

Each weapon path has an individual mastery track that progresses based on usage across matches. Mastery rewards are purely cosmetic: ability visual effects, weapon skins, player titles, and profile customisation tied to specific archetypes.

This layer gives players long-term investment in the playstyles they enjoy most. It also generates behavioral data on build popularity and engagement depth per archetype, which can directly aid future content expansion priorities and balance decisions. Mastery tracks are permanent and do not reset between seasons.

Layer 3 - Seasonal Pass

Each seasonal pass lasts approximately 3 months and has two tiers: a free track available to all players and a premium track available through purchase. Both progress through completing matches, rewarding cosmetic items such as character customisation options, ability effects, profile elements and seasonal exclusives.

The shorter pass cycle compared to the ranked season creates more frequent reward milestones and maintains engagement between major content drops. When a new season introduces significant content changes, such as the melee combat expansion, individual seasonal passes within that year can serve as the delivery vehicle for themed cosmetics tied to that expansion.

Matchmaking

NORMAL

- Meant for more relaxed, casual games or for getting used to the mechanics and limit testing
- Based on hours spent in the game

RANKED

- Meant for competitive and intense games
- Seasonal, where one season equals one year
- Based on rating

PLACEMENT	RATING CHANGE	NOTE
1st place	+15	Winner

PLACEMENT	RATING CHANGE	NOTE
2nd place	0	They live to fight another day
3rd place	-15	Eliminated first

Monetization

OverPower is a free-to-play game with cosmetic-only purchases. No purchasable item affects gameplay, stats, or competitive integrity. The monetization model is built around four revenue channels: a premium currency, a seasonal pass, a cosmetic shop with both permanent and rotating inventories, and expansion-themed bundles. Each channel targets a different spending behavior and engagement window.

Premium Currency (Credits)

All cosmetic purchases are made through Credits, a premium currency bought with real money. Credits are used across the seasonal pass premium track, the cosmetic shop, and expansion bundles. Credits can also be earned in small amounts through the free track of the seasonal pass, to give non-paying players a path toward premium items even if that path is significantly slower.

CREDITS	PRICE
500 Credits	\$4.99
1100 Credits	\$9.99
2400 Credits	\$19.99
6500 Credits	\$49.99

PLACEHOLDER VALUES

Pricing tiers are structured so that the most common purchase targets, a single shop item or the premium pass unlock, do not align cleanly with any single Credits bundle, encouraging players to buy slightly more than they need. Denominations are subject to tuning.

Seasonal Pass

The seasonal pass structure, duration, track split, and progression model are defined in Meta Progression, Layer 3. This section covers the additional systems that support it.

Weekly missions provide bonus pass progression on top of the base match completion rate. The base rate is tuned so that a player who completes most of their weekly missions finishes the pass comfortably before the end of the season, while a player who ignores missions entirely can still finish but with less room to spare. Missions rotate weekly and target varied gameplay objectives such as territory captures, kills, equipment usage and wins, to push players toward systems they might otherwise ignore. Missions should never require players to play in a way that actively harms their team or force them out of their desired playstyle.

Free track rewards include a small amount of Credits, basic cosmetic items and profile elements. Premium track rewards include higher quality cosmetics, seasonal exclusive items, and themed content tied to the current expansion if applicable.

Cosmetic Shop

The cosmetic shop has two layers: a permanent catalogue and a rotating storefront.

The permanent catalogue contains the baseline cosmetic library. These items are always available and allow players to purchase what they want on their own schedule, catering to players who prefer deliberate purchases over urgency-driven spending.

The rotating storefront features limited-time items or featured sets that cycle weekly or biweekly. These items may return in future rotations but are not guaranteed to, creating soft urgency without aggressive FOMO tactics. The storefront is also used to spotlight newly added permanent items, themed sets, or items tied to the current seasonal pass theme.

EARNED, NOT BOUGHT

Mastery track cosmetics are exclusively earned through gameplay and are never available for purchase in the shop. These items serve as visible markers of investment and skill in a specific playstyle, and their value depends entirely on not being buyable.

Expansion Bundles

Bundles are released alongside major content expansions. Each bundle is themed to match the expansion it accompanies and contains a curated set of cosmetics that would cost more if purchased individually, providing clear value to the player.

Bundles include anticipation-building mechanics before their release. A preview window of approximately one to two weeks before launch shows the bundle contents, letting players inspect individual items.

Bundles are available for a limited time window aligned with the content expansion they are tied to, and are retired once that window closes. Whether bundles return in future rotations is a content strategy decision made case by case.

LEVELS

Arena Theming & Environmental Elements

The arena's interactive elements follow the visual language defined in the Visual Theme section. All structures use clean geometry, emissive detailing, and shift to the controlling team's color when a territory is captured. Neutral or contested zones use a dim white glow.

TERRITORIES / CAPTURE ZONES

Marked by central vertical structures that pulse and intensify during capture, shifting from neutral to the capturing team's color. The capture area is marked on the ground with a geometric boundary pattern for top-down readability.

RESPAWN BEACONS

Reconstruction platforms at each capital with an upward light column or wireframe assembly effect that suggests the player is being re-rendered into the space. They permanently carry the team's color unless ownership changes during a last stand.

WALLS AND BARRIERS

Must be visually distinct at a glance. Tall walls read as solid and opaque. Jersey barriers read as shorter and semi-transparent or wireframe, communicating that projectiles pass but movement does not.

CENTRAL ZONE (TIER 4)

A distinct visual identity from other territories: a larger structure and unique floor pattern that signals strategic importance. The vision perk could be represented by a scan wave radiating outward at each refresh interval.

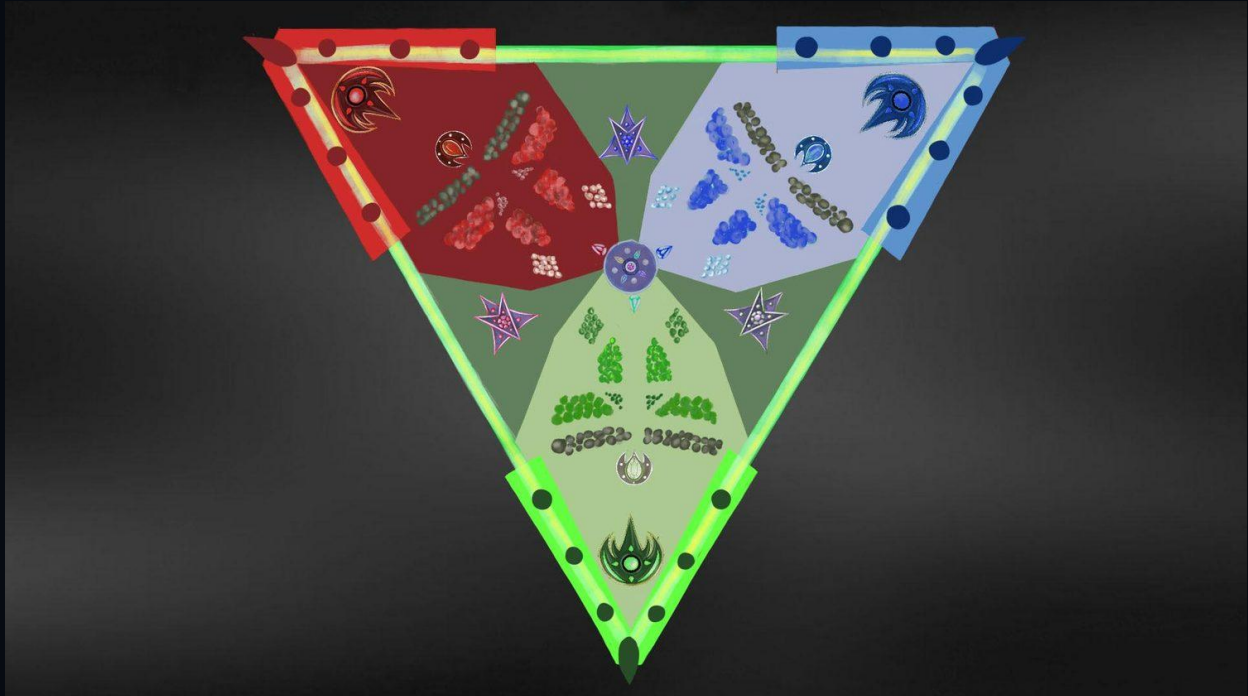
PHASE TRANSITION

Visually derezzes the eliminated team's section of the map: surfaces fragmenting, light lines extinguishing, geometry dissolving. The remaining arena briefly flickers before stabilizing into the new layout.

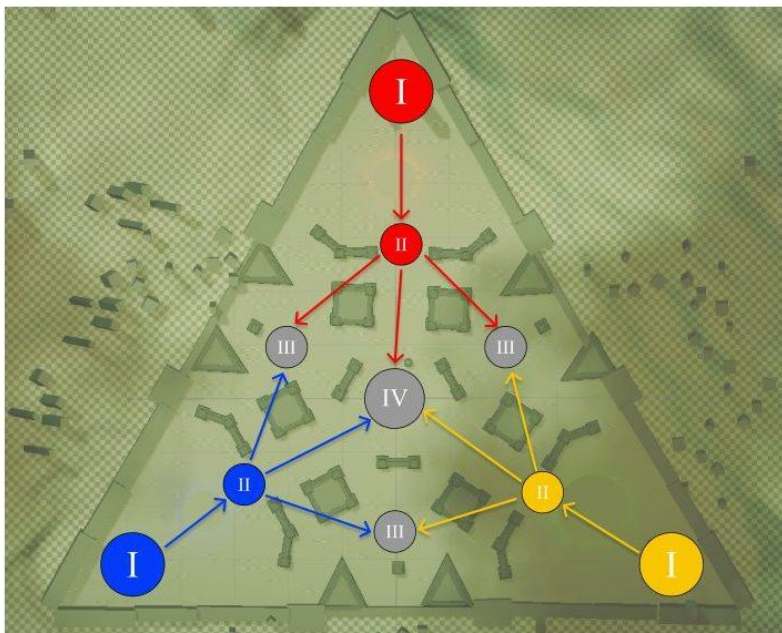
Conceptualisation

Concept Sketches

These sketches were created to help visualise key areas around the map and help with the layout for the blockout. They were made very early in the design process and do not represent the current theme in any way.



Early concept sketch

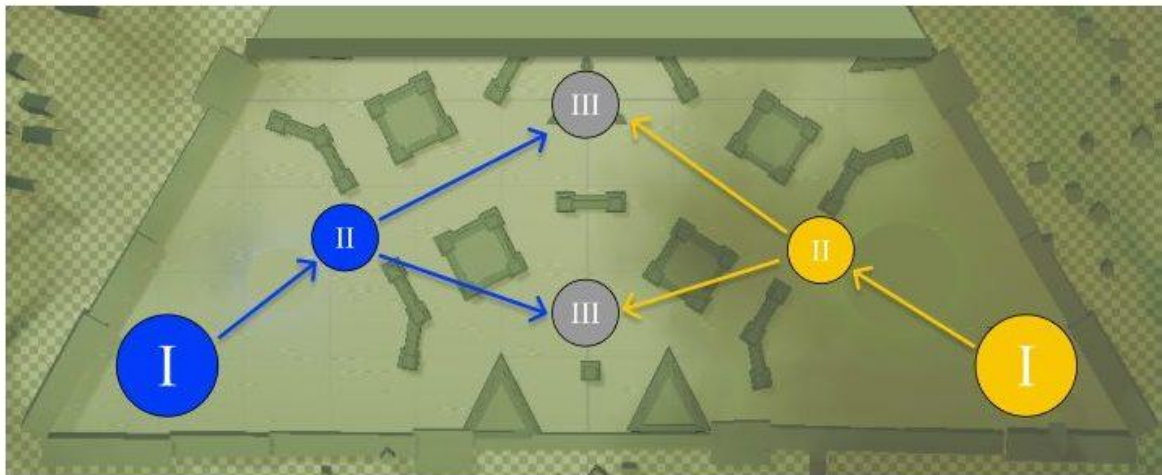


Early concept sketch

Prototyping

Initial Blockout

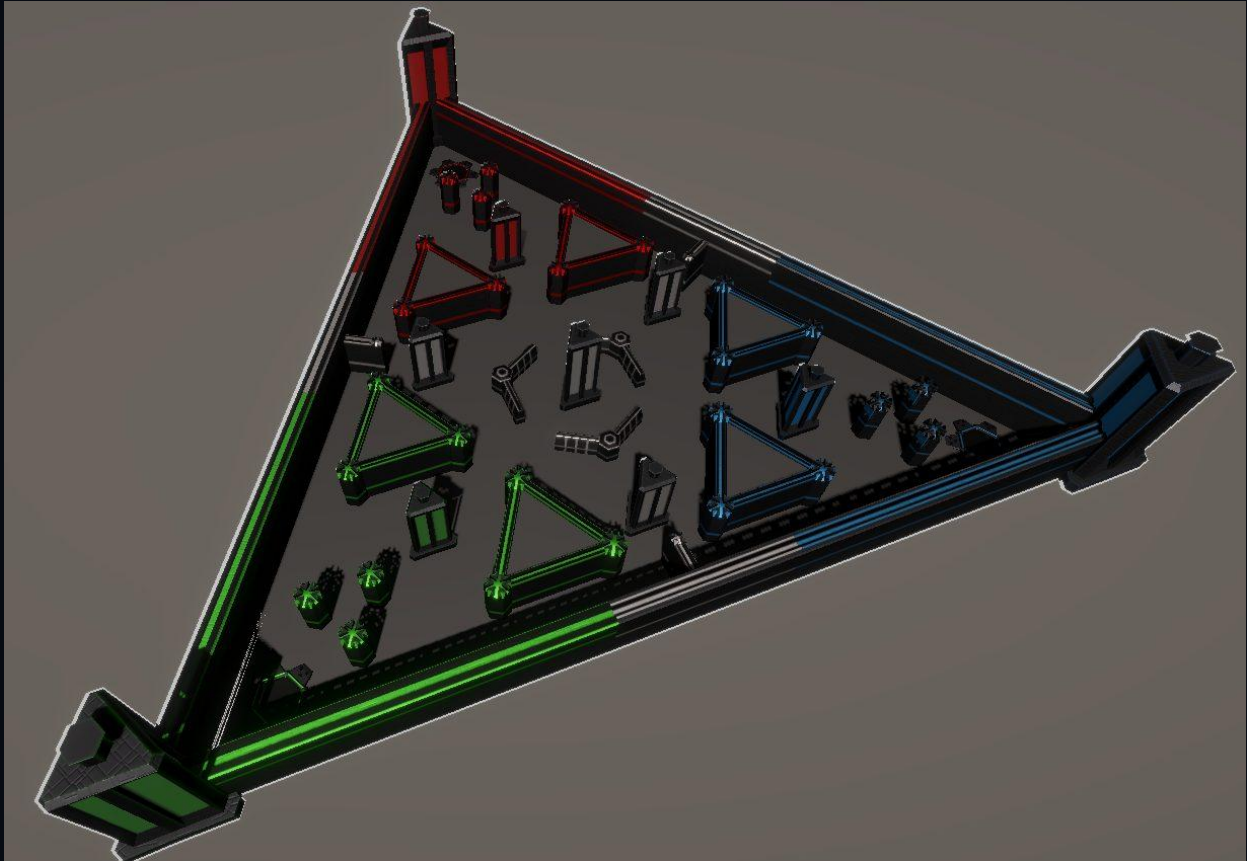
The first blockout shows how the objectives are connected to each other and general player pathing. It also showcases how the map dynamic changes after the first team elimination.



The map at the beginning of the game

LEGEND

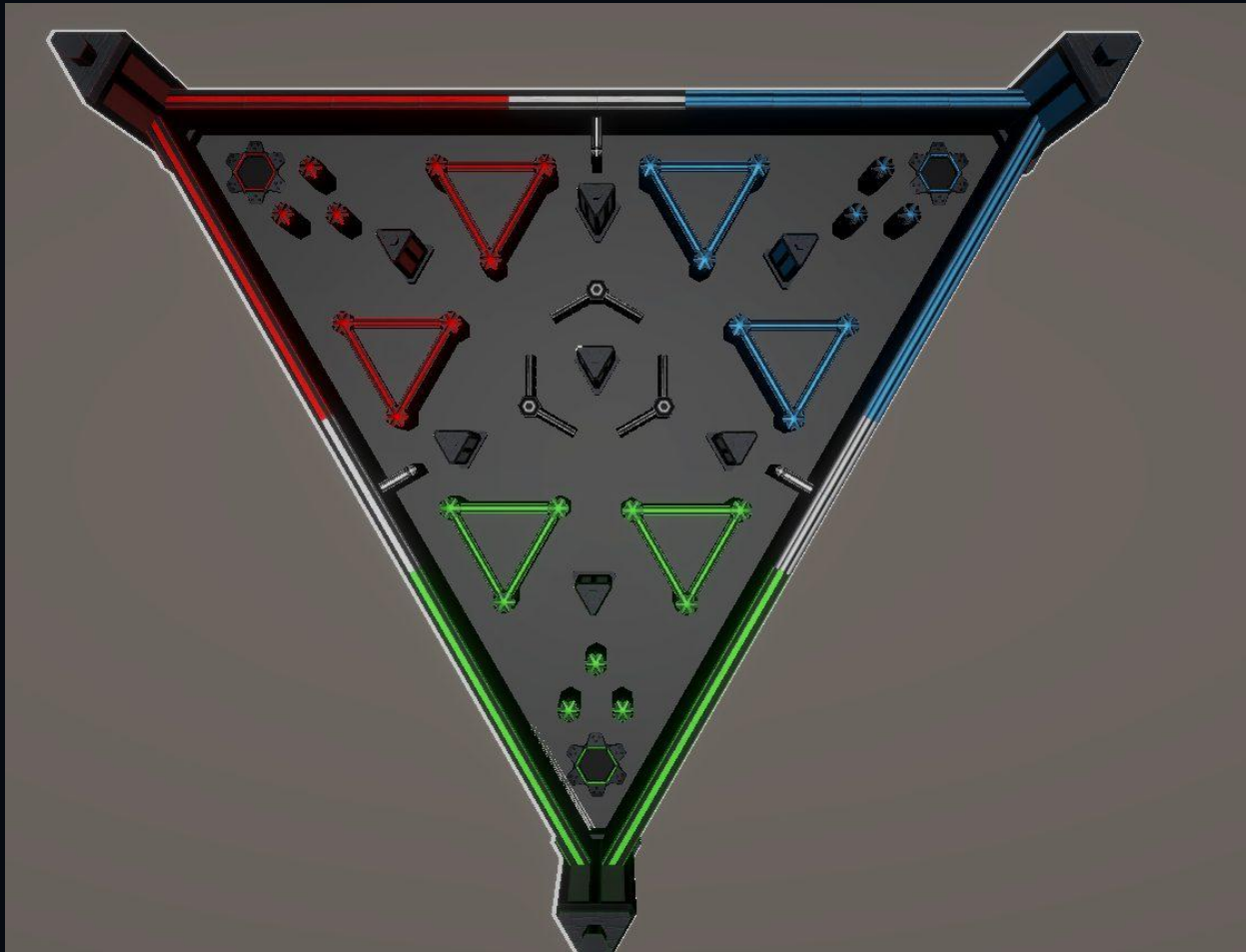
- Each bubble represents a territory
- Tier 1 (Capital) = I, Tier 2 = II, Tier 3 = III, Tier 4 = IV
- Arrows represent the connection between adjacent territories
- Each color is a different team
- The Capital (I) also serves as a respawn for the respective team



The map after one team gets eliminated

Arena

Early in development two layout variations were explored through parallel blockouts: a close quarters layout emphasizing flanking, cover usage, and tight sightlines, and an open space layout favoring precision aiming and dodging in exposed areas. After experimenting, the close quarters variation was selected as the final layout because it naturally accommodates both playstyles within a single map rather than committing entirely to one. The central zone provides open space for long range engagements while the surrounding Tier 3 zones offer the tighter geometry needed for close quarters play.



Arena blackout

Layout Design Intent

The map is structured so that each zone tier creates a distinct combat environment, and players transition between playstyles as they move across the map.

TIER 1 - CAPITAL

The safest point on the map where players respawn, heal, and shop. Enclosed with limited entry points to give defenders a spatial advantage.

TIER 2 - TRANSITION

Narrow corridors connecting capitals to contested ground. Designed as chokepoints that favor mid range combat and let defenders slow an enemy advance.

TIER 3 - FLANKING

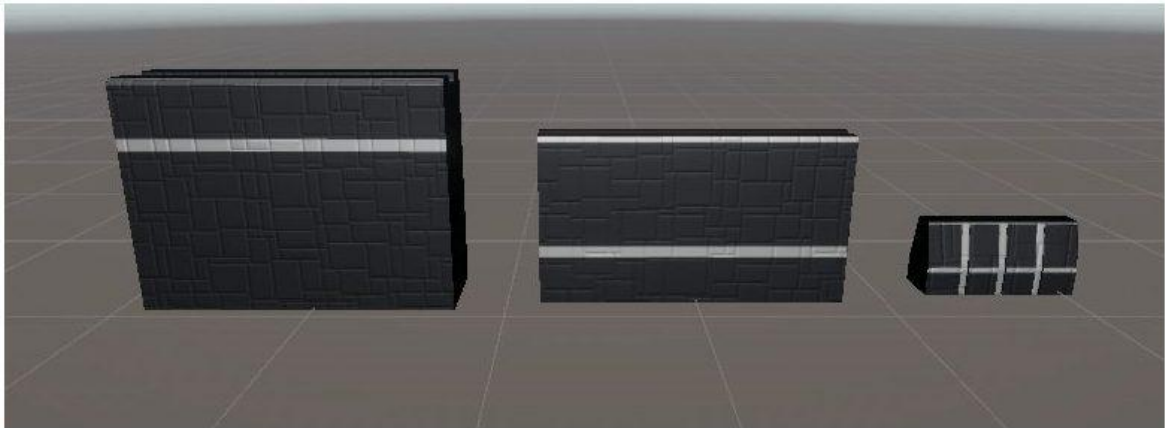
The primary contested zones between teams. Built around cover, corners, and multiple approach angles. Tall walls limit long range effectiveness and reward ambush play, movement ability usage, and positioning.

TIER 4 - CENTRAL ZONE

The most exposed point on the map. Deliberately open with only low barriers, forcing long range engagements and precision-based play. Players contesting the center are visible and vulnerable from adjacent Tier 3 zones, creating a risk-reward dynamic: highest strategic value but least physical protection.

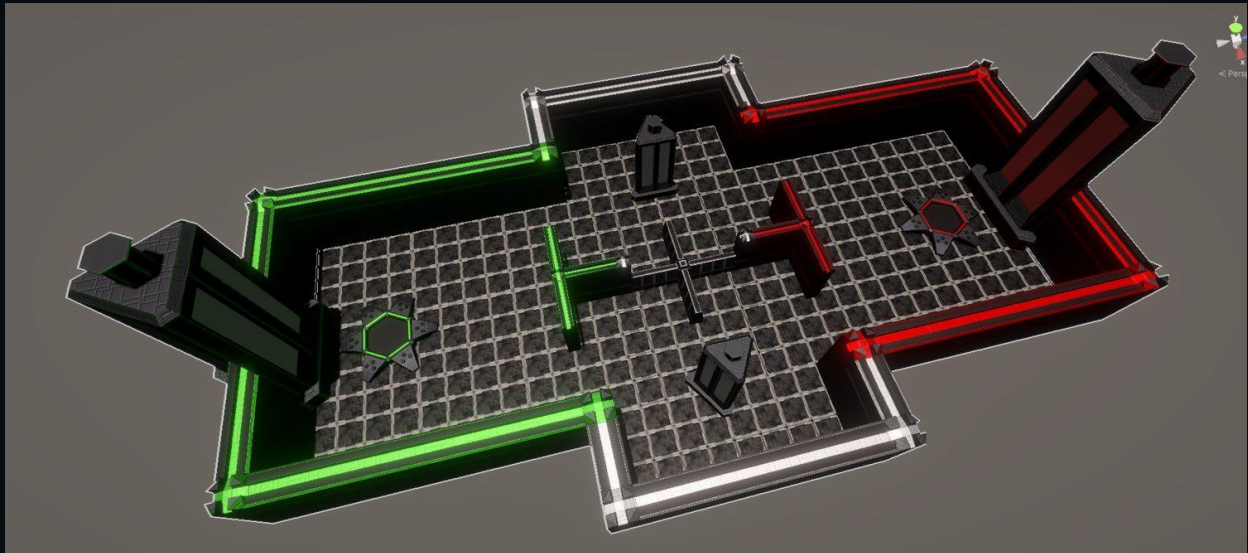
Wall Rules

Two types of obstacles define how players navigate and fight within the arena. Tall walls block both movement and projectiles, unless the player purchases a specific upgrade. They can be crossed by leaps and blinks but not dashes. Jersey barriers block movement only and allow projectiles to pass over them, and can be traversed using any movement option. The visual distinction between these two obstacle types must be immediate and unambiguous, since the difference directly affects combat decisions.



Wall and barrier types in the arena

Onboarding Level



Tutorial level layout

This is a small level where the player gets accustomed to the gameplay and the most basic interactions: contesting and capturing a territory, how adjacency works, how to generate income and how to upgrade weapons.

After this they are recommended to participate in a game against AI enemies, where pop-ups with tooltips help them navigate and understand more complex mechanics like the OverPower mechanic and Last Stand.

CONTENT

Shop

Since each round's progression is tied to upgrades, the shop contains all the content.

NOTE

All ability stats including damage values, cooldowns, durations, ranges, and other numerical parameters are documented in the Economy & Balancing spreadsheet. The descriptions below cover ability behavior and upgrade logic only.

Primary Ability

LONG RANGE TREE

Semi-automatic pistol

- Rocket launcher - explosion on impact
 - The rocket explodes at the cursor position at max range and splits into two smaller, faster rockets at a 90 degree angle, dealing 75% of the initial rocket damage
 - OR fires two rockets simultaneously, and can be charged by holding the input to shoot up to four rockets that converge at the cursor
- Laser gun - instant hitscan, generates twice the overhear but refunds half the cost if the shot connects
 - The laser can go through walls, but has a delay that also creates a visible laser in the aiming direction that other players can see
 - OR the laser becomes a continuous beam dealing more damage the more overhear the player has, and decreases overhear restore time
- Bow - shoots after a short delay, but increased damage per hit
 - Can be charged by holding the input to increase range and speed, dealing more damage based on distance travelled
 - OR the player can hop in the input direction after releasing each arrow

CLOSE QUARTERS TREE

Sub machine gun

- Sawblade launcher - projectile can hit multiple enemies
 - The projectile returns to the caster, dealing damage both ways
 - OR the projectile bounces off walls up to twice, dealing increased damage for each bounce
- Shotgun - burst of smaller projectiles in a cone
 - Becomes a scatter gun that when charged fires a projectile that explodes on impact into an outward burst of shrapnel

- OR gets explosive rounds dealing increased damage in a sweet spot at the end of the cone
- Flamethrower - continuous damage in a cone, applying a burn that stacks up to three times
 - Becomes a magma launcher that leaves lava puddles applying burn and dealing damage per second
 - OR the flames turn into a frozen shower slowing enemies 15% per stack, and at three stacks weakens the enemy to take 25% more damage from the next attack

Equipment Ability

ITEM	EFFECT
Smoke grenade	Creates a smoke screen that blocks vision
Stun grenade	Detonates, stunning enemies in an area
Deployable cover	Creates cover that blocks incoming projectiles, expires after 10 seconds
Throwing knife	Applies a bleed damage-over-time effect that ignores armor
Harpoon	Projectile that deals damage scaling with missing enemy HP
Shockwave	Self-cast AoE that knocks back enemies
Explosive mine	Becomes invisible after 1 second, deals damage when an enemy walks over it
Surveillance drone	Grants vision in a radius, two charges, can be destroyed if shot

Ultimate

- Multi-person teleporter with start-up duration
- Electric fence surrounding the caster that damages and slows enemies passing through it
- Multi-dash mark that deals damage based on the number of dashes the target was hit with
- Self-cast AoE radius lasting 6 seconds, dealing damage every second
- Self-cast buff making the caster immune to damage but stunned for the duration

Movement Ability

- Short dodge roll with two charges
- Long blink with a 10 second cooldown
- 50% movement speed buff with two charges
- Leap that damages and slows enemies upon landing

Passive

- Movement speed buff when hitting an enemy
- Increased damage against enemies under 30% HP
- Health restoration when eliminating an enemy, not on participation
- Out of combat health regeneration
- Increased damage against shields
- Refunded cooldown and overhear reduction when eliminating an enemy

- Damage reduction when the shield is broken

Content Expansion

Since this is a live service game, content needs to be added constantly to keep player retention. Apart from new upgrades and weapons, a new melee combat system is also proposed for later expansions.

PROPOSED MELEE SYSTEM

Players can no longer purchase an equipment ability and instead only a weapon of their choice. This weapon has two attacks available from the start: light attack on left click and heavy attack on right click. With the early version the player can only use those two, but upon upgrading, the weapon not only improves its stats but the light and heavy attacks change and can be sequenced to create combos. Each weapon has its own unique combos and can have more gimmicks depending on the type of weapon and the level it was upgraded at.

GAME ECONOMY & BALANCING

Playtime

Each round lasts approximately 25 minutes, in a range of 20 to 30, and is split into three stages.

EARLY GAME

From the beginning of the game until around the 10 minute mark. Players look to keep control over as many territories as they can to increase gold generation, by engaging in skirmishes with other contestants.

MID GAME

Starts when players upgrade their primary ability to change their projectile. Each team is looking for an advantage to siege another team and potentially eliminate them.

LATE GAME

Starts when players have almost completely upgraded their kits. There are usually only two teams remaining, and each is looking to close out the game by eliminating the opposition.

Economy Assumptions

MATCH PARAMETERS

PARAMETER	VALUE	NOTES
Target match duration	1350 sec	22.5 min midpoint
Players per team	3	Fixed 3v3v3
Phase 1 duration	900 sec	~15 min, three teams alive
Phase 2 duration	450 sec	~7.5 min, two teams alive

TERRITORY INCOME

PARAMETER	VALUE	NOTES
Tier 3 income	10 g/sec	Primary income driver, flanking zones
Tier 2 income	5 g/sec	Secondary income
Tier 4 - Central Zone	8 g/sec	Strategic vantage, income secondary

PARAMETER	VALUE	NOTES
Tier 1 - Capital	0 g/sec	Respawn and health regen only
Capture bounty - Tier 3	900	
Capture bounty - Tier 2	0	
Capture bounty - Tier 4	1200	
Vision perk refresh	10 sec	Owner sees adjacent zone status

UPGRADE COSTS (GOLD PER PLAYER)

UPGRADE	COST	NOTES
Primary - Upgrade 1 (projectile type)	1200	
Primary - Upgrade 2 (final upgrade)	1600	
Armor - Upgrade 1	1400	
Armor - Upgrade 2	1800	
Ultimate ability	1550	
Passive ability	2200	
Sell refund rate	0.5	50% of purchase cost returned
Total, all six upgrades	9750	Used in gold flow surplus calc

INTENDED PURCHASE TIMING (AVERAGE SCENARIO)

PURCHASE	TIMING	NOTES
Primary Upgrade 1	~6.5 min	First return trip, build foundation
Armor Upgrade 1	~10 min	
Ultimate	~13.5 min	Mid game power spike
Primary Upgrade 2	~16.5 min	Final weapon form
Armor Upgrade 2	~20 min	Late game survivability
Passive	Phase 2	

Gold Flow Simulator

Per player, from one team's perspective. All rates pull from the assumptions above.

PHASE 1 - THREE TEAMS ALIVE

SCENARIO	T3	T4	T2	INCOME/SEC	PHASE 1 GOLD
Losing	0	0	1	5	1500
Struggling	1	0	1	15	4500

SCENARIO	T3	T4	T2	INCOME/SEC	PHASE 1 GOLD
Average	1	1	1	23	6900
Dominant	2	1	1	33	9900

PHASE 2 - TWO TEAMS ALIVE

SCENARIO	T3	T4	T2	INCOME/SEC	PHASE 2 GOLD
Losing	0	0	1	5	750
Even	1	0	1	15	2250
Winning	2	0	1	25	3750

FULL MATCH ESTIMATE - AVERAGE SCENARIO

LINE	GOLD
Phase 1 gold, per player	6900
Phase 2 gold, per player	2250
Estimated capture bounties (2 captures)	900
Total estimated gold	10050
Total upgrade cost, all six upgrades	9750
Surplus / deficit	+300

Catchup & Bounty Analysis

Models the gold gap between the dominant and losing team, and whether bounties are sufficient to close it.

GOLD GAP OVER TIME

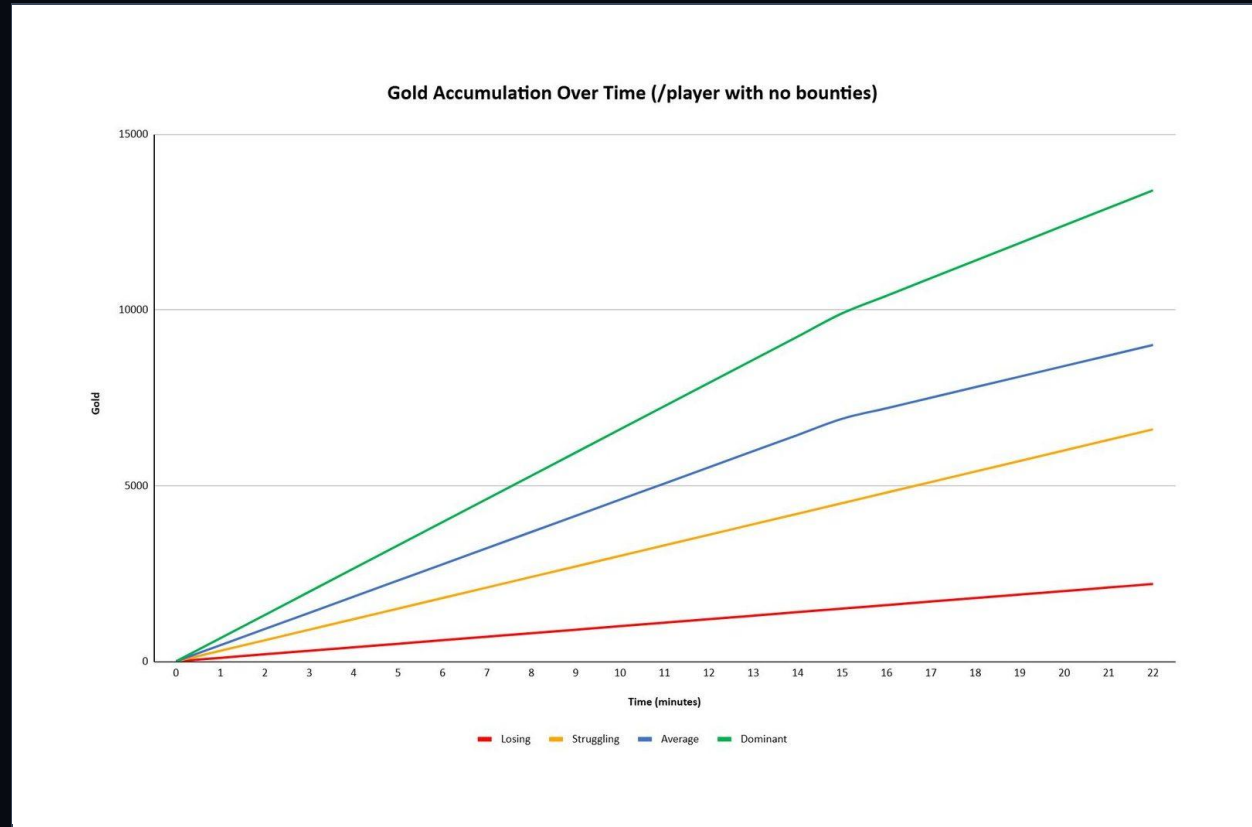
TIME ELAPSED	DOMINANT	LOSING	GAP	BOUNTIES TO CLOSE
120 sec	1320	200	1120	2
300 sec	3300	500	2800	4
600 sec	6600	1000	5600	7
900 sec	9900	1500	8400	10

BOUNTY IMPACT - HOW MUCH OF THE GAP DOES ONE CAPTURE CLOSE?

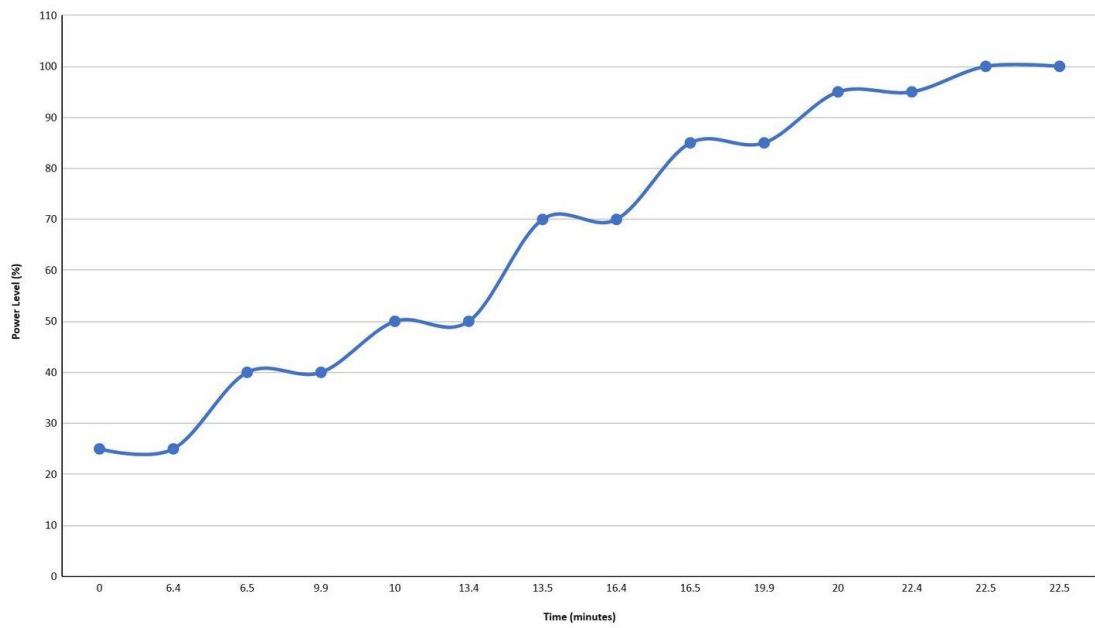
CAPTURE EVENT	GAP	BOUNTY	REMAINING	% CLOSED
Capture Tier 3 at 5 min	2800	900	1900	32.1%
Capture Tier 4 at 5 min	2800	1200	1600	42.9%
Capture Tier 3 at 10 min	5600	900	4700	16.1%

Balancing Sheets

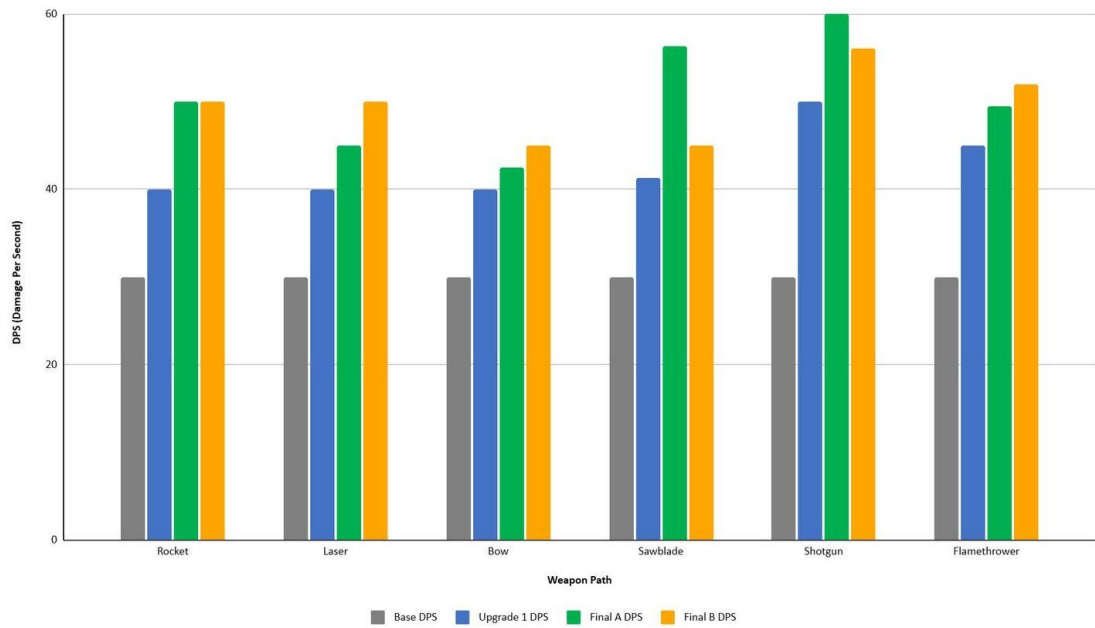
The charts below visualise the economy model: income curves, upgrade affordability windows, and the effect of bounties on the gold between teams.



Player Power Curve (Average Scenario)



DPS Comparison Across All Weapon Paths



Stat / Parameter	Semi-Auto (Base)	SMG (Base)
Damage / projectile	30	15
Fire rate (shots/sec)	1	2
Projectile speed	8	7
Projectile size	4	3
Accuracy	9	7
Range	9	6
Overheat / shot	8	4
DPS (dmg × rate)	30	30
Stat / Parameter	Semi-Auto (Base)	SMG (Base)
	Semi-auto pistol. High damage per shot, strong accuracy at standstill, long range. Low fire rate.	SMG. Fast fire rate, low overheat per shot, strong accuracy while moving. Lower damage per bullet.

◀ LONG RANGE TREE (Semi-Auto Pistol path)								
ROCKET LAUNCHER			LASER GUN			BOW		
Upg 1 Rocket	Final A Split Rockets	Final B Double+Charge	Upg 1 Laser	Final A Wall Pierce	Final B Beam Mode	Upg 1 Bow	Final A Charge Shot	Final B Hop Release
40	50	25	40	45	25	80	85	90
1	1	2	1	1	2	0.5	0.5	0.5
8	10	8	instant	instant	instant	10	13	10
6	6	7	2	2	3	4	4	4
8	8	8	11	10	11	11	13	11
10	11	12	13	15	12	13	16	13
11	13	14	13	14	16	10	11	10
40	50	50	40	45	50	40	42.5	45
UPGRADE DESCRIPTIONS								
Upg 1 Rocket	Final A Split Rockets	Final B Double+Charge	Upg 1 Laser	Final A Wall Pierce	Final B Beam Mode	Upg 1 Bow	Final A Charge Shot	Final B Hop Release
Projectiles now explode on impact at the cursor position (within max range). Slower fire rate, larger AoE.	Rocket explodes at cursor, then splits into 2 smaller faster rockets at 90° angles dealing 75% of initial damage.	Fires 2 rockets simultaneously. Hold input to charge up to 4 rockets that converge on cursor position.	Instant hitscan. Generates 2x overheat when fired but refunds 50% cost if the shot connects with an enemy.	Laser can pierce through walls but has a startup delay that briefly shows the aim direction to all players.	Becomes a continuous beam. Deals more damage the higher the caster's overheat. Also reduces overheat restore time.	Fires after a short draw delay. Increased damage per hit. Good range and accuracy when stationary.	Hold input to charge. Increases arrow range and speed. Damage scales with distance the arrow travels.	Player hops in the input direction after releasing each arrow— provides mobility while maintaining fire.

◀ CLOSE QUARTERS TREE (SMG path)								
SAWBLADE LAUNCHER			SHOTGUN			FLAMETHROWER		
Upg 1 Sawblade	Final A Return	Final B Bounce	Upg 1 Shotgun	Final A Scatter/Shrapnel	Final B Explosive Rounds	Upg 1 Flamethrower	Final A Magma Launcher	Final B Frozen Shower
55	45	60	10	12	14	15	16.5	13
0.75	0.75	0.75	5	5	4	3	3	4
7	6	8	6	6	6	5	4	5
8	9	8	1	3	1	5	8	6
7	7	7	5	4	5	5	4	5
4	3	5	3	2	2	2	2	2
3	2	2	5	7	7	6	8	7
41.25	56.25	45	50	60	56	45	49.5	52
Upg 1 Sawblade	Final A Return	Final B Bounce	Upg 1 Shotgun	Final A Scatter/Shrapnel	Final B Explosive Rounds	Upg 1 Flamethrower	Final A Magma Launcher	Final B Frozen Shower
Projectile hits multiple enemies it passes through. Moderate speed, large size, shorter range.	Sawblade returns to the caster after reaching max range, dealing damage both on the way out and 50% of the base damage on the way back.	Sawblade bounces off walls up to 2 times. Each bounce deals 10% increased damage and extends reach. (up to 3 bounces)	Fires a burst of smaller projectiles in a cone. Strong at close range, weak at distance.	When charged, fires a single projectile that explodes on impact into an outward burst of shrapnel.	Rounds now have explosive tips. Deals increased damage in a sweet spot at the far end of the cone.	Continuous cone of fire. Applies burn stacking up to 3 times (2 dmg/sec per stack for 3 sec).	Becomes a magma launcher. Leaves lava puddles that apply burn AND deal 5 dmg/sec while enemy is inside.	Flames turn icy. Slows enemies 15% per stack. At 3 stacks: enemy takes 25% bonus damage from next hit.

EQUIPMENT ABILITY BALANCE - 2ND SLOT

Placeholder values - requires playtesting for proper balancing

Stat / Parameter	Smoke Grenade	Stun Grenade	Deployable Cover	Throwing Knife	Harpoon	Shockwave	Explosive Mine	Surveillance Drone
Cooldown (sec)	10	12	15	10	20	12	15	10
Charges	1	1	1	1	1	1	3	2
Charge Cooldown (sec)	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	5
Damage	0	0	0	5 dmg/sec (bleed)	20 (base)	15	25	0
Duration (sec)	5	2	10	3	N/A	N/A	N/A (until triggered)	30 (or until destroyed)
Area / Radius (m)	5	4	N/A	N/A (projectile)	N/A (projectile)	5	2.5	7.5
HP	N/A	N/A	50	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	25
Special Effect	Blocks vision	Stuns for 2 sec	Blocks projectiles	Ignores armor	Scales with missing HP	Knocks back enemies	Invisible after 1 sec	Grants vision
Knockback Distance (m)	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	6	N/A	N/A
Projectile Speed	N/A (thrown)	N/A (thrown)	N/A	8	10	N/A (self-cast)	N/A (thrown)	N/A (thrown)
Max Deploy Count	N/A	N/A	1	N/A	N/A	N/A	3	2

ABILITY DESCRIPTIONS

Stat / Parameter	Smoke Grenade	Stun Grenade	Deployable Cover	Throwing Knife	Harpoon	Shockwave	Explosive Mine	Surveillance Drone
Description	Creates a smoke screen that blocks vision in the target area.	Detonates stunning enemies for 2 seconds in an area.	Creates a 75 HP cover that blocks incoming projectiles. Expires after 10 seconds.	Applies a bleed damage over time effect that ignores armor (5 dmg/sec for 3 seconds).	Projectile that deals damage scaling with missing enemy HP (base 15 damage).	Self-cast AoE that knocks back enemies.	Throws down a mine that becomes invisible after 1 second and deals 30 damage when an enemy walks over it (max 3 mines deployed).	Throws down a gadget that grants vision in a 7.5m radius. Has 2 charges (5 sec cooldown/charge). Can be destroyed if shot.

ULTIMATE ABILITIES (3RD SLOT)

Stat / Parameter	Multi Teleporter	Electric Fence	Multi Dash	AoE Pulse	Immunity
Resource Cost (meter %)	100	100	100	100	100
Startup Duration (sec)	1.5	0.5	0	0	0
Duration (sec)	Instant (channel)	5	N/A (burst)	6	3.5
Damage	0	15 dmg/tick	20 per dash (scaling)	10 dmg/sec	0
Damage Ticks / Interval	N/A	1 per sec	N/A	1 per sec	N/A
Total Potential Damage	0	75	60	60	0
Radius / Range (m)	12	6	8	6	N/A (self)
Slow %	N/A	25	N/A	N/A	N/A
Stun Duration (sec)	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	3.5
Dash Count	N/A	N/A	3	N/A	N/A
Damage Scaling	N/A	N/A	+10 per consecutive hit	N/A	N/A
Targets	Team (up to 3)	Enemies passing through	Enemies in path	Enemies in radius	Self
Special Effect	Teleports team to target location	Fence surrounds caster, slows + damages	Marks targets, damage scales with dash count	Persistent AoE around caster	Immune to damage but stunned for duration

ULTIMATE DESCRIPTIONS

Stat / Parameter	Multi Teleporter	Electric Fence	Multi Dash	AoE Pulse	Immunity
Description	Multi person teleporter with start up duration. Teleports entire team to target location.	Electric fence surrounding caster that deals damage and slows down enemies passing through it.	Multi dash mark that deals damage based on the number of dashes the target was hit with.	Self cast AoE radius that lasts for 6 seconds dealing 10 damage every second.	Self cast buff that makes the caster immune to damage for 3.5 seconds but also stuns them for the duration.

MOVEMENT ABILITIES (4TH SLOT)

Stat / Parameter	Dodge Roll	Blink	Speed Buff	Leap
Cooldown (sec)	3	10	8	6
Charges	2	1	2	1
Distance (m)	3	10	N/A	7
Duration (sec)	N/A (instant)	N/A (instant)	2	N/A
Speed Bonus (self)	N/A	N/A	50%	N/A
Damage	0	0	0	25
Slow on Landing %	N/A	N/A	N/A	20
Slow Duration (sec)	N/A	N/A	N/A	1.5
Wall Interaction	Cannot cross tall walls	Crosses all walls	N/A	Crosses all walls
Barrier Interaction	Crosses barriers	Crosses barriers	N/A	Crosses barriers
Special	N/A	Can be cast at cursor (shorter range)		Damages and slows on landing

MOVEMENT DESCRIPTIONS

Stat / Parameter	Dodge Roll	Blink	Speed Buff	Leap
Description	Short dodge roll with 2 charges (3 sec cooldown per charge).	Long blink with 10 second cooldown. Can be cast at cursor position if full length is not necessary.	50% movement speed buff that also buffs nearby allies for 20% (8 second cooldown).	Leap that damages and slows down enemies upon landing (6 seconds cooldown).

VISUALS & AUDIO

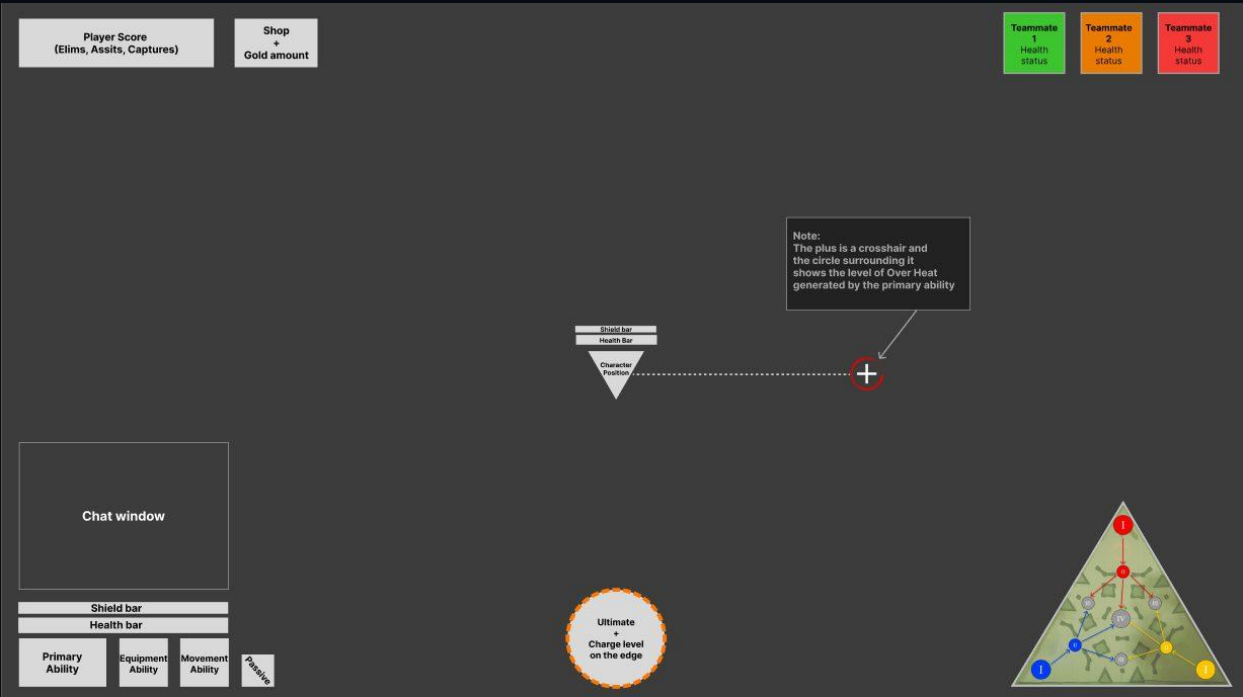
Mockups

HUD Mockup

PASSIVE ABILITY BALANCE - 5TH SLOT							
Placeholder values - requires playtesting for proper balancing							
Stat / Parameter	Speed on Hit	Execute Damage	Kill Heal	OOO Health Regen	Shield Breaker	Reset on Kill	Shield Break DR
Effect	10% move speed on hit	10% bonus dmg < 30% HP	15 HP on elimination	Regen HP out of combat	25% bonus dmg vs shields	50% CD + overheat refund on kill	35% DR when shield breaks
Trigger Condition	Hitting an enemy	Enemy below 30% HP	Getting the final blow	6 sec out of combat	Attacking shielded target	Getting the final blow	Shield breaking
Duration (sec)	8	N/A (passive)	N/A (instant)	Continuous while OOC	N/A (passive)	N/A (instant)	12
Internal Cooldown (sec)	8	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	12
Regen Rate (HP/sec)	N/A	N/A	N/A	5	N/A	N/A	N/A
Stacks	No	No	No	N/A	No	No	No
Notes	Rewards aggressive play and chasing	Finisher passive, pairs well with burst builds	Sustain passive, only on final blow not assists	Enables longer rotations between territories	Counter-pick against armor-heavy opponents	Snowball passive for high-skill players	Defensive passive, helps survive burst after shield goes down DR = Damage Reduction

HUD layout mockup

Visual Theme & Direction



Visual direction reference

The arena exists inside The Stream, a digital environment built to test human consciousness under pressure. The visual language reflects this: everything the player sees is constructed, authored, and artificial, but rendered with enough fidelity and spatial logic to feel like a real place rather than an abstract void.

The primary reference point is the aesthetic of TRON: hard-edged geometry, luminous surface lines, and environments that read as physical spaces while clearly communicating that nothing here is organic. OverPower pushes this in a brighter direction. Where TRON uses deep black as its dominant tone with sharp contrast lighting, OverPower's arena uses a lighter neutral base with neon edge lighting and emissive surface detailing providing color and visual hierarchy. This keeps the top-down perspective readable at all times and ensures ability effects and player models remain distinct against the environment.

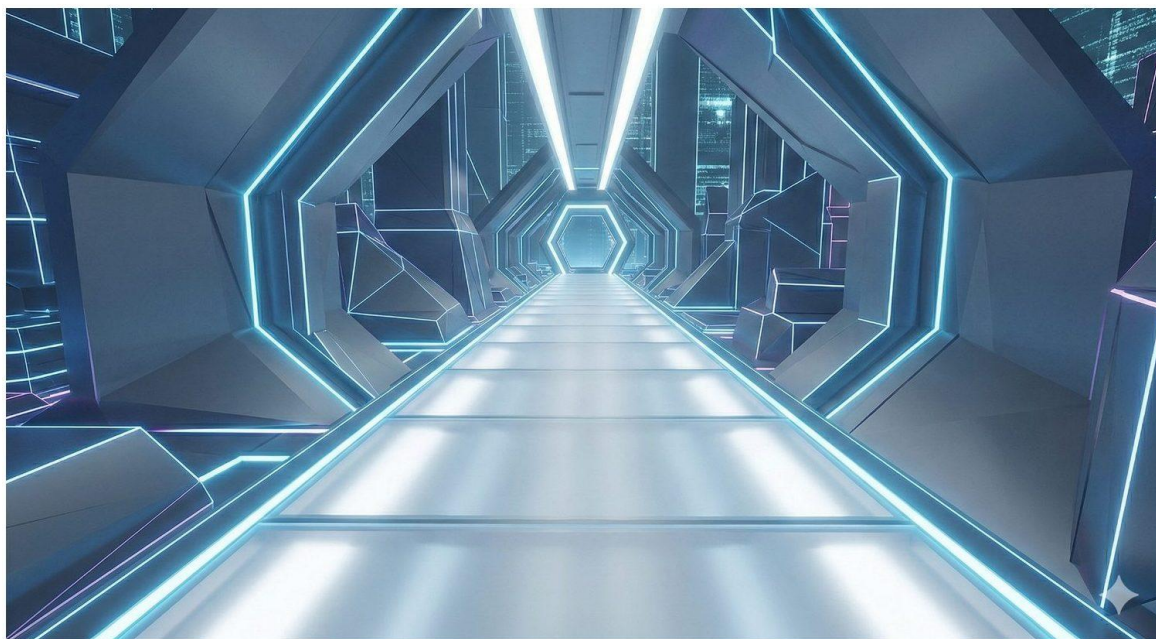
The arena is built from clean, modular geometry: flat planes, angular platforms, beveled walls, and tessellated floor grids. Surfaces have a faint translucency or glass-like quality, as if the environment is a projection rendered onto a structural framework. Edges and seams glow with thin emissive lines that pulse subtly, suggesting the space is active and processing. The overall impression should be architectural rather than organic: this is a place that was designed, not grown.

COLOR IS FUNCTIONAL, NOT DECORATIVE

The base arena palette is neutral - greys, dark blues, soft whites - and territory control is communicated through color saturation. When a team captures a zone, the emissive lines, floor patterns, and structural highlights within that territory shift to the controlling team's color. Neutral or contested territories use a dim white. This creates a dynamic map where territorial control is immediately visible from the top-down camera without needing UI overlays.

Lighting is predominantly emissive and ambient. There are no strong directional light sources like sunlight, since this is an interior digital space. Light comes from the surfaces themselves: glowing floor grids, emissive wall edges, territory markers, and ability effects. This self-lit quality reinforces the simulation aesthetic while keeping visibility consistent across the entire map.

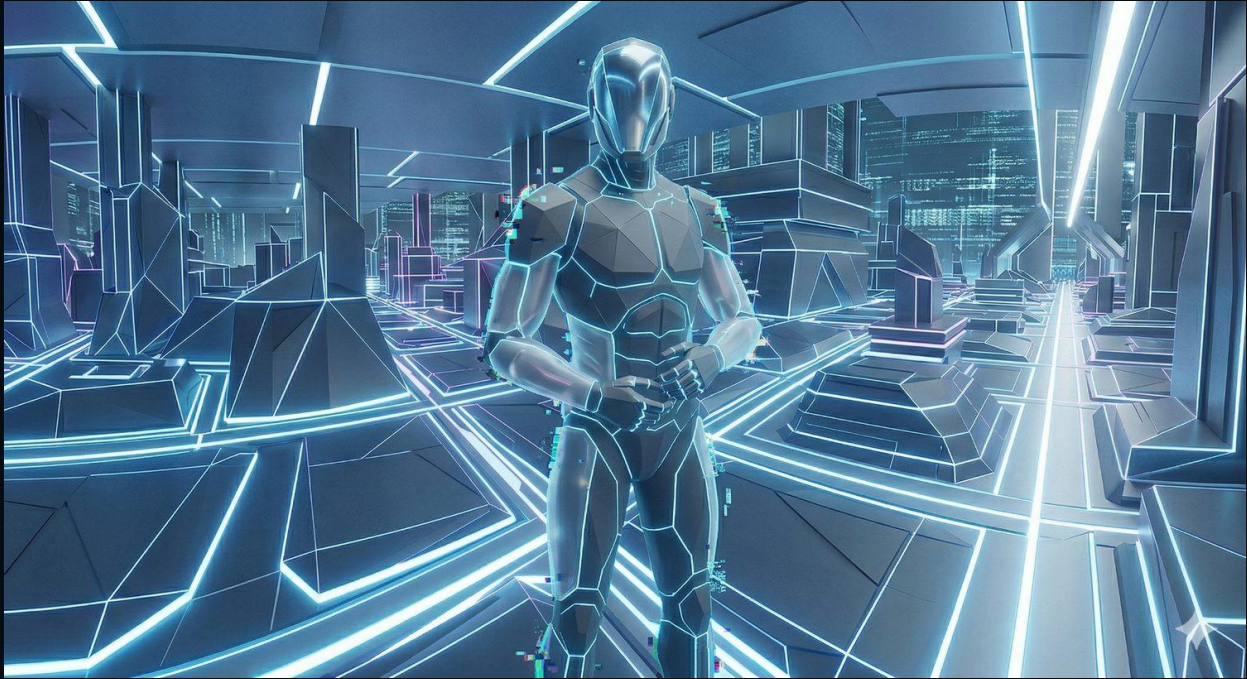
Character Visual Direction



Character direction reference

Contestants are human in form, but exist inside a digital space where self-presentation is authored rather than biological. Character customisation should reflect this: the visual tools available to players should feel like editing a digital avatar rather than dressing a physical body. Materials on character models should include elements that would not exist on a real person: emissive skin patterns, translucent limbs, geometric plating, glitch-like visual artifacts at the edges of a silhouette. The key constraint is that every contestant must read as a person at a glance from the top-down camera. Silhouette clarity comes first, expressive customisation second.

Team color should be present on player models through accent lighting or an emissive outline, to ensure team identification is instant from any camera distance.



Music & SFX

The background music is electronic and EDM oriented, matching the digital aesthetic of The Stream. Tempo and intensity scale with the match state.

STAGE	TEMPO	DIRECTION
Early Game	120 - 130 BPM	Atmospheric and restrained. Steady pulse, minimal melody, ambient texture. Supports focus without overwhelming.
Mid Game	140 - 150 BPM	Heavier synths, aggressive basslines, sharper percussion. Ramps up as teams commit to engagements.
Late Game / Phase 2	150 - 170 BPM	Peak intensity. Faster, denser, driving. Matches the urgency of a two-team final without becoming fatiguing.

TRANSITIONS

Transitions between tempos should be triggered by match events such as phase transitions and territory thresholds, rather than fixed timers, so the music always reflects the actual state of the game.

Sound Effects

Crisp, short, layered feedback for:

- Ability cast, preferably different depending on ability type
- Hit and impact types
- Ultimate ready and activation
- Capture start, contest and complete
- Enemy elimination or participation (assist)

- Team elimination
- Respawn